

# Round 3 — “The Investigation”

11:00 PM – Midnight

**Scene:** Hard evidence. Investigation by conversation. Press the alibis. Look at the body. Open bags. Two visual climaxes anchor the round (the five browns, then Val cleared / Marco’s eyewitness moment) — these are run by characters in the room, not by the host.

- **Already revealed.** Federal badge in hand. Drive the room.
- **Share in conversation:**
  - **Sasha’s USB drive:** Open the envelope mid-round. Plug it into a phone or laptop. Read aloud one line: *“Paloma’s whistleblower file. Names Gloria as the head of the laundering ring. Names Doug. Names Val’s hotel group. Marco-adjacent trusts. Dated last week.”*
- **Seek out:** Sasha (thank her — she’s earned it), Lorraine (take her client list), Gloria (don’t speak; just stand near her).

## Your moment to drive — the Five Browns (the visual climax of the round)

This beat is yours. The host does not run it. Run it when Irina has broken, Pepe has surfaced the coffee tin, the cotton ball, and the needle cap, and the room is ready to look at the body.

- **Cross to Gloria.** Badge in hand.
- **You:** “Mrs. Reyes. Your bag.”
- **Gloria:** “You can’t be serious.”
- **You:** “Empty it.”
- **Gloria** will place items on the table, one at a time, in silence:
  1. The printed Diego photo.
  2. The handkerchief — red Kool-Aid drop + brown smear visible.
  3. The brown Sharpie wrapped in masking tape labeled “INSULIN.”
- **Pick up the Sharpie. Peel back the masking tape.** Hold it up so the room can see the bare Sharpie underneath. Deliver evenly: *“Mrs. Reyes, you are not diabetic. And this is a Sharpie.”*
- **Now line up the five browns.** Hold the Sharpie next to the stain on Paloma’s collar, next to the brown smear on Gloria’s handkerchief, next to the stain on Gloria’s cuff, next to the powder in Irina’s coffee tin. **Five matching browns in a line.** Take your time. Let the room see all five.
- **Call to Dex at the bar:** “Mr. Calloway. The thermos.”
- **Dex** will pull the thermos out from under the bar. Open it. Steam, real coffee, different shade. Pour a cup on the bartop.
- **Deliver, evenly:** *“That is coffee. This is the same brown as the stain on Ms. Rathbone’s collar.”*
- **Gloria says nothing.** Let the silence land. You’re done.

(Irina will confirm the powder in her tin with a nod when you hold it up. She doesn’t have to speak.)